

Word family: **steady** / **steadier** / **steadiest** / **steadily** / **steadiness** / **steadying**

Base word: **steady**

Comparative: **steadier**

Superlative: **steadiest**

Related forms: **steadily**, **steadiness**, **steadying**

Useful expressions / extensions: **steady pace**, **steady hand**, **steady job**, **steady relationship**, **steady growth**, **hold steady**, **steady yourself**

Part of speech: **adjective** (形容詞) / **adverb-related form** (相關副詞) / **verb** (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “Kindness can be quiet, **steady**, and deeply powerful.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **steady** means **consistent, reliable, and not easily changed or disrupted over time**.

The speaker is describing kindness that is not dramatic or flashy, but **continues calmly and reliably**.

繁體中文： **持續而穩定、不容易動搖或中斷的；可靠而有持久性的**

中文翻譯：

> “Kindness can be quiet, **steady**, and deeply powerful.”

「善良可以很安靜、很**穩定而持久**，卻也非常有力量。」

Here:

steady kindness = 長時間保持一致、可靠而不張揚的善意

1. **steady** = **stable** / **not changing much** (穩定的) — 穩定的；平穩的

This is the exact core sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Kindness can be quiet, **steady**, and deeply powerful.”

「善良可以很安靜、很**穩定持久**，卻非常有力量。」

Practice 2

> “She made **steady** progress.”

「她取得了**穩定的進步**。」

Practice 3

> “The company has shown **steady** growth.”

「公司一直保持**穩定增長**。」

steady = 狀態、進展或表現持續一致，沒有突然大幅改變

2. **steady** = physically firm / not shaking (穩的) — 穩定的；不搖晃的

Practice 4

> “Keep your hand **steady**.”

「保持手部**穩定**，不要抖動。」

Practice 5

> “The table is not very **steady**.”

「這張桌子不太**穩固**。」

steady = 身體、物件或動作保持穩定，不晃動、不顫抖或不失去平衡

3. **steady hand** (手穩 / 沉著) — 穩定的手；沉著能力

Practice 6

> “A surgeon needs a **steady hand**.”

「外科醫生需要有一雙**穩定的手**。」

Practice 7

> “She painted the fine details with a **steady hand**.”

「她用**很穩的手**畫出細節。」

****steady hand = 手部控制穩定，不容易抖動****

Figuratively, it can also imply calm control.

4. ****steady = calm / emotionally controlled (情緒穩定) — 沉著的；冷靜的****

Practice 8

> “She kept her voice ****steady****.”

「她保持聲音****平穩鎮定****。」

Practice 9

> “He remained ****steady**** under pressure.”

「他在壓力下仍然保持****沉著穩定****。」

****steady = 情緒、語氣或反應不因壓力而劇烈波動****

5. ****steady voice / breathing (平穩) — 平穩的；均勻的****

Practice 10

> “She spoke in a ****steady voice****.”

「她用****平穩的聲音****說話。」

Practice 11

> “His breathing became ****steady**** again.”

「他的呼吸再次變得****平穩****。」

****steady = 聲音、呼吸或節奏均勻，不忽快忽慢或忽強忽弱****

6. ****steady pace / speed (速度) — 穩定的；均勻的****

Practice 12

> “Walk at a **steady pace**.”

「以**穩定的步速**行走。」

Practice 13

> “The car maintained a **steady speed**.”

「汽車保持**穩定車速**。」

steady pace/speed = 速度大致保持一致，不突然加快或減慢

7. **steady flow / supply** (流量 / 供應) — 持續穩定的

Practice 14

> “There was a **steady flow** of visitors.”

「訪客一直**穩定地陸續到來**。」

Practice 15

> “The factory needs a **steady supply** of materials.”

「工廠需要**穩定持續的原材料供應**。」

steady = 持續出現 / 供應，而且數量或頻率相對穩定

8. **steady income/job** (收入 / 工作) — 穩定的；可靠的

Practice 16

> “He wants a **steady job**.”

「他想找一份**穩定的工作**。」

Practice 17

> “A **steady income** gives people more security.”

「**穩定收入**會令人更有安全感。」

****steady job/income = 能持續存在、提供可靠收入或保障的工作 / 收入****

9. ****steady relationship (關係) — 穩定的 ; 持久的****

Practice 18

> “They have been in a ****steady relationship**** for years.”

「他們多年來一直維持一段****穩定的感情關係****。」

Practice 19

> “She prefers a ****steady**** relationship to something casual.”

「她比較喜歡****穩定長久的關係****，而不是隨意的關係。」

****steady relationship = 持續、可靠、相對穩定而不反覆變化的關係****

10. ****steady = regular / continuous (固定持續) — 持續的 ; 規律的****

Practice 20

> “There was a ****steady**** rain all afternoon.”

「整個下午一直下著****持續而穩定的雨****。」

Practice 21

> “She heard a ****steady**** tapping sound.”

「她聽到一陣****持續而規律的敲擊聲****。」

****steady = 某件事持續發生，節奏或強度相對規律****

11. ****steady = dependable / reliable (可靠的) — 穩重可靠的****

Practice 22

> “He is a ****steady**** and dependable worker.”

「他是一個**穩重可靠的員工**。」

Practice 23

> “She has always been a **steady presence** in the family.”

「她一直是家中一個**穩定可靠的存在**。」

****steady = 一個人長期表現可靠、一致，不容易失控或突然改變****

This is very close in tone to your grandmother passage.

12. ****steady presence (穩定存在) — 穩定而令人安心的存在****

Practice 24

> “Her grandmother was a **steady presence** throughout her childhood.”

「她外婆在她整個童年都是一個**穩定而令人安心的存在**。」

Practice 25

> “His calm, **steady presence** reassured everyone.”

「他平靜而**穩定的存在感**令大家安心。」

****steady presence = 長時間保持可靠、沉著和支持作用的人 / 存在****

13. ****steady progress (穩步進展) — 穩定進步；穩步發展****

Practice 26

> “The student is making **steady progress**.”

「這名學生正在**穩步進步**。」

Practice 27

> “Recovery has been slow but **steady**.”

「康復雖然慢，但一直**穩定進展**。」

****steady progress = 不一定很快，但持續而可靠地向前發展****

14. ****steady growth/increase (穩定增長) — 穩步增長****

Practice 28

> “Sales showed a ****steady increase****.”

「銷售錄得****穩定增長****。」

Practice 29

> “The population has grown at a ****steady rate****.”

「人口一直以****穩定速度****增長。」

****steady growth/increase = 數值持續上升，但沒有劇烈波動****

15. ****hold/remain steady (保持穩定) — 維持不變；保持平穩****

Practice 30

> “Prices remained ****steady****.”

「價格保持****穩定****。」

Practice 31

> “Hold the camera ****steady****.”

「把相機****拿穩****。」

****remain/hold steady = 保持原本穩定狀態，不明顯移動、波動或改變****

16. ****steady — verb = make something stable (使穩定) — 穩住；使平穩****

Now ****steady**** functions as a verb.

Practice 32

> “She used the wall to **steady** herself.”

「她扶著牆壁來**穩住自己**。」

Practice 33

> “He reached out to **steady** the chair.”

「他伸手去**扶穩椅子**。」

steady someone/something = 令某人 / 某物停止搖晃、失衡或不穩

17. **steady yourself** (穩住自己) — 站穩；鎮定自己

This can be physical or emotional.

Practice 34

> “She paused to **steady herself** before standing.”

「她停了一下，先**穩住身體**再站起來。」

Practice 35

> “He took a deep breath to **steady himself**.”

「他深呼吸一下，好讓自己**鎮定下來**。」

steady yourself = 使自己的身體重新平衡，或令自己的情緒恢復冷靜

18. **steady nerves/emotions** (使情緒平復) — 穩住；鎮定

Practice 36

> “She took a moment to **steady her nerves**.”

「她花了一點時間讓自己**鎮定下來**。」

Practice 37

> “His calm words helped **steady** everyone.”

「他平靜的話語幫助大家**穩定情緒**。」

steady = 令緊張、害怕或激動的情緒恢復平穩

19. **steadily = at a constant rate (穩定地) — 穩定地；持續地**

The main adverb form.

Practice 38

> “The temperature rose **steadily**.”

「溫度**穩定地持續上升**。」

Practice 39

> “She has been improving **steadily**.”

「她一直**穩步進步**。」

steadily = 以持續、一致而沒有劇烈變化的方式

20. **steadily = without shaking (穩穩地) — 平穩地；不抖地**

Practice 40

> “Hold the cup **steadily**.”

「把杯子**穩穩地拿著**。」

Practice 41

> “She looked **steadily** at him.”

「她**定定地 / 穩定地**望著他。」

steadily = 以不晃動、不移開或保持一致的方式

21. **steadiness = physical stability (穩定性) — 穩定；平穩**

Practice 42

> “The job requires great hand **steadiness**.”

「這份工作需要很高的手部**穩定性**。」

Practice 43

> “The camera’s **steadiness** improved the image.”

「相機的**穩定性**改善了影像效果。」

steadiness = 不搖晃、不失去平衡或保持穩定的程度

22. **steadiness** = emotional reliability/calmness (沉著 / 穩重) — 沉著；穩定性

Practice 44

> “Everyone admired her emotional **steadiness**.”

「大家都欣賞她情緒上的**沉著穩定**。」

Practice 45

> “His **steadiness** during the crisis reassured the team.”

「他在危機中的**沉著穩重**令團隊安心。」

steadiness = 面對壓力或困難仍保持冷靜、一致和可靠的特質

23. **steadying** = making something more stable/calming (穩定 / 安定作用) — 令人穩定的；安定的

A useful participial/adjectival form.

Practice 46

> “Her voice had a **steadying effect** on him.”

「她的聲音對他有一種**安定情緒的作用**。」

Practice 47

> “He placed a **steady hand** on her shoulder.”

「他把手放在她肩上，給她一種**穩定 / 安慰作用**。」

steady = 令某人 / 某物變得更穩、更冷靜或更有安全感的

24. **steady on!** (英式口語) — 慢著；冷靜點；別過火

A lexicalized informal expression.

Practice 48

> “**Steady on!** There’s no need to get angry.”

「**冷靜點！不用生氣。**」

Practice 49

> “Steady on—you’re moving too fast.”

「**慢著 / 別急！你進度太快了。**」

steady on = 用來叫人冷靜、慢一點或不要反應過度

Register: informal, especially British English.

Important distinction: **steady vs stable**

These overlap strongly.

steady

often emphasizes:

> little fluctuation or continuous consistency over time.

> “steady growth”

stable

often emphasizes:

> unlikely to collapse, change drastically, or become uncontrolled.

> “a stable economy”

Both can mean 「穩定」, but **steady** often has a stronger sense of **continuous regularity**.

Important distinction: **steady vs **constant****

**steady**

= relatively even and consistent.

**constant**

= continuous or unchanged, often more absolute.

> “steady rain”

= 持續而規律地落雨

> “constant rain”

= 雨幾乎不停地下

So **constant** can sound stronger.

Important distinction: **steady vs **regular****

**steady**

focuses on consistent rate/intensity.

**regular**

focuses on occurring according to a repeated pattern or schedule.

> “a steady flow”

= 流量持續平穩

> “regular visits”

= 定期探訪

They overlap but emphasize different things.

Important distinction: **steady vs calm**

steady

can mean emotionally controlled, but it also applies to:

- * physical movement

- * income

- * growth

- * supply

- * pace

calm

mainly focuses on:

> absence of agitation, stress, anger, or disturbance.

> “a calm person”

versus:

> “a steady person”

The second suggests reliability and consistency as well as calmness.

Important distinction: **steady vs reliable**

reliable

= can be trusted to perform as expected.

steady

= consistent, stable, and not prone to sudden change.

A **steady worker** is often reliable, but **steady** emphasizes consistency of behaviour/performance.

Important distinction: **steady vs firm**

steady

= not shaking/changing.

firm

= physically solid or decisively strong.

> “Keep your hand steady.”

= 手不要抖。

> “Hold it firmly.”

= 緊緊 / 牢牢握著。

Not the same.

Important distinction: **steady vs still**

steady

= controlled and stable, possibly while still moving.

still

= not moving.

A camera moving smoothly can be:

> steady

without being:

> still.

Important distinction: **steady growth vs rapid growth**

steady growth

= consistent growth over time.

It may be slow or moderate.

rapid growth

= fast growth.

So **steady** describes consistency, not speed.

Important distinction: **steady job vs permanent job**

steady job

= reliable ongoing employment/income.

permanent job

= formally not temporary/fixed-term.

A job can be steady without technically being permanent.

Important distinction: **steady relationship vs serious relationship**

steady relationship

focuses on:

> consistency and continuity.

serious relationship

focuses on:

> commitment and emotional importance.

They often overlap, but are not identical.

Important distinction: ****steady yourself — physical vs emotional****

Physical:

> “She held the rail to steady herself.”

= 她扶著欄杆站穩。

Emotional:

> “She took a breath to steady herself.”

= 她深呼吸讓自己鎮定。

Same verb, two closely related extensions based on restoring stability.

Important distinction: ****steady vs steadily****

****steady****

adjective:

> “steady progress”

= 穩定的進展

****steadily****

adverb:

> “progress steadily”

= 穩步進展

Important distinction: ****steadiness vs stability****

****steadiness****

often emphasizes:

- * lack of shaking
- * consistency
- * emotional composure

stability

is broader and common for:

- * systems
- * economies
- * structures
- * political situations
- * chemicals

For personality:

> emotional steadiness

sounds especially natural.

Family-extension note

Following the reference curation style, these are especially useful members and constructions of the **steady** family:

- * **steady — stable/consistent** = 穩定的
- * **steady — physically firm** = 穩的 / 不抖的
- * **steady hand** = 穩定的手
- * **steady — emotionally controlled** = 沉著的
- * **steady voice/breathing** = 平穩的聲音 / 呼吸
- * **steady pace/speed** = 穩定速度
- * **steady flow/supply** = 穩定持續的流量 / 供應
- * **steady job/income** = 穩定工作 / 收入
- * **steady relationship** = 穩定持久的關係
- * **steady presence** = 穩定可靠、令人安心的存在
- * **steady progress/growth** = 穩步進展 / 增長
- * **hold/remain steady** = 保持穩定
- * **steady — verb** = 穩住
- * **steady yourself** = 穩住身體 / 鎮定自己
- * **steady nerves/emotions** = 平復情緒
- * **steadily** = 穩定地 / 持續地
- * **steadiness** = 穩定性 / 沉著
- * **steadying effect** = 安定 / 穩定作用

* **steady on!** = 慢著 / 冷靜點 (英式口語)

As in the reference methodology, many of these uses share the underlying semantic core
***“remaining stable rather than fluctuating, shaking, or becoming disrupted.”** They should
therefore be taught as related branches rather than artificially split into unrelated meanings.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
steady — stable/consistent	狀態、表現或進展持續一致，沒有突然大幅改變
steady — physical	保持平衡、不搖晃、不顫抖或不容易倒下的
steady hand	手部控制穩定、不容易抖動
steady — emotional	情緒、語氣或反應在壓力下仍保持平穩和沉著
steady voice/breathing	聲音、呼吸或節奏均勻而不突然變化
steady pace/speed	速度大致保持一致，不突然加快或減慢
steady flow/supply	持續出現 / 供應，數量或頻率相對穩定
steady job/income	能持續提供可靠工作 / 收入和一定保障的
steady relationship	持續、可靠而不反覆變化的關係
steady — regular/continuous	某件事情持續發生，節奏或強度相對規律
steady — dependable person	長期表現可靠、一致而不容易失控的人
steady presence	長時間提供可靠、沉著和令人安心支持的存在
steady progress	不一定很快，但持續可靠地向前發展
steady growth	數值持續上升而沒有劇烈波動
hold/remain steady	保持原本穩定狀態，不明顯移動或波動
steady — verb	令某人 / 某物停止搖晃、失衡或不穩
steady yourself — physical	使自己的身體重新取得平衡
steady yourself — emotional	令自己的情緒恢復平靜和控制
steadily — consistency	以持續、一致、沒有劇烈變化的方式
steadily — physically	以不晃動、不顫抖的方式
steadiness — physical	不搖晃、不失衡並能保持穩定的程度
steadiness — emotional	面對壓力仍能保持冷靜、一致和可靠的特質
steadying	能令某人 / 某物變得更穩、更冷靜或更有安全感的

For your original sentence

> “Kindness can be quiet, **steady**, and deeply powerful.”

The exact meaning is:

****steady = 長時間保持一致、可靠和穩定，不會因環境或困難而輕易中斷或改變****

Therefore:

> ****steady kindness****

= ****「持續而可靠、不張揚但長久存在的善意」****

The word is doing something important here.

The passage is not describing kindness as:

> dramatic

> intense

> occasional

Instead, it is:

> ****quiet + steady + powerful****

So the grandmother's kindness is powerful precisely because it is ****consistent over time****—making tea, cutting fruit, listening first, accepting the speaker, and offering thoughtful advice.

That connects naturally to another useful expression from the same family:

> ****a steady presence****

= ****「一個長期穩定、可靠而令人安心的存在」****

which closely captures how the grandmother is portrayed throughout the passage.